

LEGO Classic Kits

WHAT'S IN THE KIT

- 3 LEGO Classic kits with assorted bricks, wheels, and base elements



QUICK-START GUIDE

1. Set the challenge before the bricks come out — constraints spark creativity.
2. Use trays or mats to define each builder's space.
3. Photograph builds before teardown so work is preserved.
4. Sort-by-color cleanup races actually work.

FULL LESSONS IN THIS GUIDE

GRADES K-2	Build-a-Setting Retell	page 2
GRADES 3-5	20-Brick Challenge	page 3

PRO TIP: Pairs beautifully with writing: build first, then describe or narrate the build.

LEGO Classic Kits

LESSON · GRADES K-2

Build-a-Setting Retell

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Students will represent a story's setting in a 3D build
- Students will retell a plot using the build as a prop
- Students will listen and add to a partner's retelling

MATERIALS

- LEGO Classic kits split into group trays
- A read-aloud picture book
- Building mats
- Retelling sentence starters (First... Then... Finally...)

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Read the story; list its important places on the board together.
2. Groups choose and build one setting from the story.
3. Builders narrate: walk a minifigure/brick 'character' through the plot in their setting.
4. Partner swap: retell the story using someone else's build.
5. Photo-document builds before cleanup.
6. Retell round two the next day using only the photos.

ACTIVITY

Build-a-Setting Retell — comprehension disguised as play: build the setting, then walk the story through it. Retelling in someone else's build is the sneaky stretch goal.

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LESSON · GRADES 3-5

20-Brick Challenge

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Students will create within tight material constraints
- Students will generate multiple solutions to one prompt
- Students will give and receive structured critique

MATERIALS

- Identical 20-brick sets (pre-bagged per student)
- Prompt cards ('something that flies', 'something that helps')
- Voting tokens
- Gallery table space

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Every student gets the same 20 random bricks — no trades, no additions.
2. Reveal the prompt; 15 minutes of silent solo building.
3. Gallery walk: builds displayed with title cards.
4. Structured critique rounds: 'I notice... I wonder...' at three builds each.
5. Token voting for categories: most creative, best use of a weird piece, most functional.
6. Rebuild round with the same bricks and a new prompt — fluency through constraint.

ACTIVITY

20-Brick Challenge — identical bricks, one prompt, wildly different answers. Constraint-based creativity plus critique protocol in a single class period.